



ChartDrop

Spreadsheet numbers into Figma Slides charts, styled to match your deck. 33 chart types. The complete guide.

VERSION 1

What ChartDrop does

You have numbers in a sheet. You need a chart in the deck, on brand, today. ChartDrop reads the data, reads your deck, and draws the chart on the slide to match. You check it in the preview, press Insert, done.

Reads your deck

Fonts, text colour, the colours already on your slides, gridline colour and text size are detected from the slide and the deck around it. No template setup.

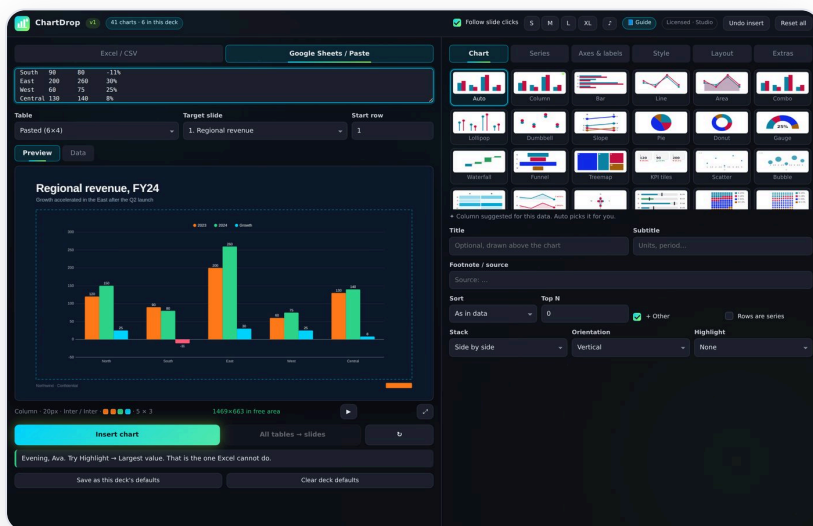
Fits the slide

Finds the free space between title and footer, sizes the chart to it (S/M/L/XL), anchors it where you want.

Stays editable

The result is plain Figma shapes, vectors and text in one frame. Move a label, recolour a bar, the normal way.

The window at a glance



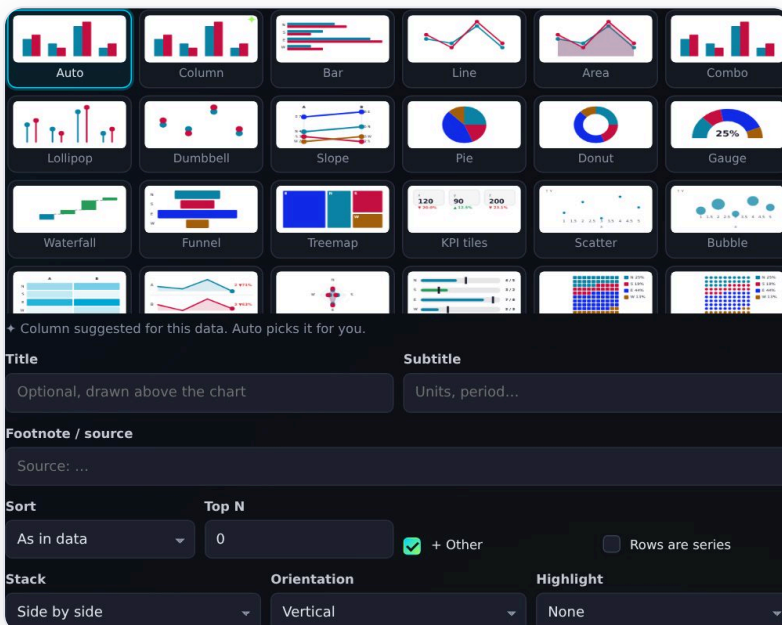
Left: source, target slide, preview or data grid, insert. Right: six settings tabs. Everything on the right updates the preview instantly, without a round trip to Figma.

Area	What it is for
Source tabs	Load an Excel/CSV file, or paste a range copied from Google Sheets or Excel.
Table / Target slide / Start row	Which table from the file, which slide it goes on, which row holds the headers.
Preview / Data	Preview shows the real slide with the chart animated onto it. Data is where you fix the numbers.
Chart · Series · Axes & labels · Style · Layout · Extras	Every control, grouped. Hover any control for about a second to get a short explanation.
Insert chart	Builds it on the slide. Ctrl + Enter does the same.

First chart in 60 seconds

Open a Figma Slides deck, run ChartDrop from Plugins, and follow along.

- 1 Load the data.** Click `Choose File` and pick the .xlsx or .csv. Or open `Google Sheets / Paste`, select the range in Sheets or Excel, copy, and paste it in the box. First row = headers. One column = categories (names, months). The other numeric columns = series.
- 2 Pick the slide.** Click the slide in Figma; the **Target slide** dropdown follows you.
- 3 Pick a chart.** The ♦ mark shows the type ChartDrop suggests for this shape of data. **Auto** uses it. Or click any of the 33 thumbnails.
- 4 Look at the preview.** The dashed box is the free area found on the slide. The line under the preview tells you the type, font size and how many points it drew.
- 5 Insert.** Click `Insert chart`. Figma jumps to the slide with the chart selected.



The type picker. Every thumbnail is drawn by the same engine that draws the real chart.

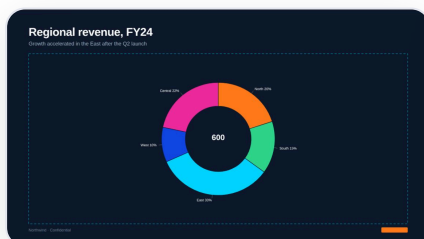
Wrong category column? Series tab → Category column. Or right-click a column in the Data tab → Use as category column.

Not happy? `Undo insert` removes what you just inserted. Or just insert again: the same table on the same slide replaces the previous chart.

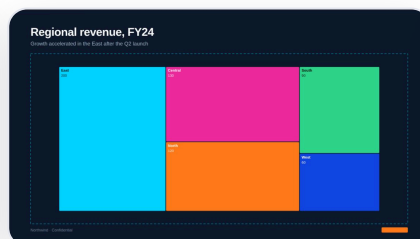
Chart types (33)

Grouped by what they are for. All of them read the same data shape: categories down, series across.

Family	Types	Data shape
Compare	Column, Bar, Ranking, Lollipop, Dumbbell, Slope, Bullet, Radar	Categories + 1 or more series. Dumbbell and Slope use the first two series.
Over time	Line, Area, Combo, Sparklines, Small multiples, Candlestick, Timeline, Gantt	Time down the rows. Candlestick: Open, High, Low, Close. Gantt: Start, End.
Part of whole	Pie, Donut, Gauge, Treemap, Waffle, Pictograph, Proportion, Funnel, Waterfall	Categories + one series. Waterfall reads rows named Total / Net / End as totals.
Distribution	Scatter, Bubble, Histogram, Box plot, Heatmap	Scatter: X and Y columns. Bubble: + size column. Box plot: each row a group, values across.
Numbers	KPI tiles, Progress	KPI: one tile per row, first numeric column = value, second = comparison.



Donut with deck colours



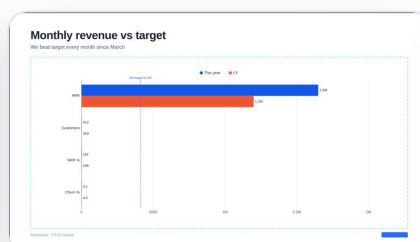
Treemap



Waterfall



KPI tiles with delta



Bar, sorted high to low



Line, latest point highlighted

Never in Excel

The features that make a chart tell a story instead of just showing numbers.

Highlight

Chart tab → Highlight. Greys everything except the largest value, the latest point, the negatives, or one slice. One click, the eye goes where you want.

Annotations

Click any bar, point or slice in the preview, type the note. Or Extras → + Annotation. Placed on the real chart in Figma.

Computed series

Series → Computed: % change, difference, cumulative, 3-point average, share of total, index. Without touching the sheet.

Deck palette

The saturated colours already on your slides become the series colours. Style → Palette to switch to hue, mono, greyscale or your own swatches.

Story sequence

Layout → Story sequence. One slide per category (or per series), each highlighting the next. A reveal deck built for you, cloned from the target slide.

Delta callout

Extras → From / To / Series → Add Δ. Computes the change and the percent and drops it on the chart.

Forecast

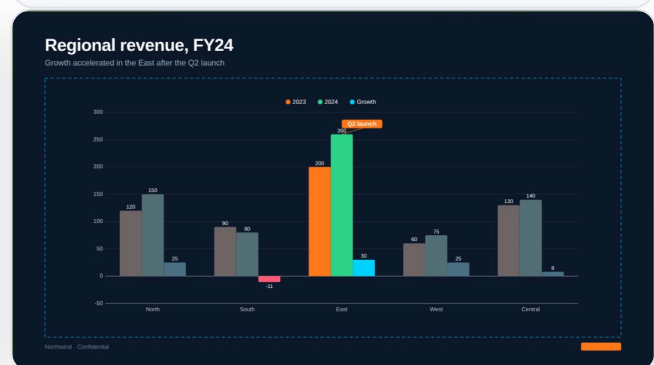
Axes → Forecast points. A dashed linear projection of the first line, N points ahead.

Hand-drawn / Print

Style tab. Hand-drawn wobbles every shape for workshops. Print mode goes greyscale for handouts.



Highlight → Largest value



Click-to-annotate

Series, axes & labels

Series

Category column

Size column (bubble)

Computed series

Region

None

None

☐ Show computed series only

☐ Colour by category

	Column	Display name	Kind	Axis	Colour	
☒	2023	2023	Auto	y		
☒	2024	2024	Auto	y		
☒	Growth	Growth	Auto	y		

Kind = bar / line / area per series (combo). Axis y2 puts a series on a right-hand axis. Custom colour overrides the palette for that series.

Category column, size column for bubbles, computed series, and one row per numeric column: on/off, display name, kind (bar / line / area for combos), axis (y or y2 on the right), custom colour.

Axes & labels

Number format

Decimals

Prefix

Suffix

Auto

1

\$

k

☒ Value labels

Label only

Label position

Label kind (pie)

All

Outside

Name + %

☒ Gridlines

☒ Axis numbers

Y min

Y max

auto

auto

X axis title

Y axis title

Missing values

Gap

☐ Smooth lines

☐ Markers

☐ Stepped

Forecast points

0

☐ Trend line (scatter)

☐ Series name at line end

☒ Negatives red

REFERENCE LINES

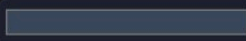
+ Reference line

Number format (auto, integer, fixed, K/M/B, percent, prefix, suffix), value labels (all, largest, first & last, latest), label position and kind, gridlines, axis numbers, y min / max, axis titles, missing values, smooth, markers, stepped, forecast, trend line, series name at line end, negatives in red, reference lines (value, average, target).

Combo charts. Set one series to Bar and another to Line in the Series tab, or pick Combo and let it decide. Put a percentage series on y2 so it gets its own axis.

Style & layout

Style

Palette	Accent	Text	Lines
Deck colours			
☐ Use the colour overrides above			
Corner radius	Bar gap	Line width	Area opacity
auto	auto	auto	auto
☐ Print mode ☐ Hand-drawn ☐ Card background ☒ Slice gaps (pie)			
Donut thickness	Explode slice #		
0.42	none		
FONTS			
Body font	Style	Heading font	Style
Deck font (auto)	—	Auto (bold cut)	—
Font size	☒ Cap to deck body size		
auto (deck body size)			

Palette mode, accent / text / lines overrides (tick "Use the colour overrides" or they stay on deck colours), corner radius, bar gap, line width, area opacity, print mode, hand-drawn, card background, pie slice gaps, donut thickness, exploded slice, fonts (deck fonts listed first), font size and the cap to the deck body size.

Layout

Size	Aspect	Horizontal	Vertical
L · 85%	Free	Centre	Middle
Margin %	Legend	Nudge X	Nudge Y
5	Top	0	0
☒ Replace previous insert of this table ☐ Lock after insert			
Story sequence	Name (for replace / amend)		
Off	auto from table name		
TYPE-SPECIFIC			
KPI tiles by	KPI compare to	Small multiples / row	Histogram bins
Auto	vs LY	auto	auto
Gauge / progress max	Centre text (donut)	Centre label	☒ Donut centre total
auto	auto		
☒ KPI sparkline	☐ Stack totals	☒ Waterfall connectors	☒ Funnel conversion % ☐ Treemap %
☒ Small multiples shared scale			

Size S/M/L/XL of the free area, aspect ratio, anchor, margin, legend position, nudge, replace previous insert, lock, story sequence, name, and the type-specific knobs.

Save as this deck's defaults stores the current settings inside the Figma file. Everyone who opens ChartDrop on that deck starts from them.

Data tab, amend, batch

Data

+ Row ↑	+ Row ↓	+ Col ←	+ Col →	Del rows	Del cols	Row ↑	Row ↓	Promote to header	Transpose
Undo	Export CSV								
	A	B	C	D					
1	Region	2023	2024	Growth					
2	North	120	150	25%					
3	South	90	80	-11%					
4	East	200	260	30%					
5	West	60	75	25%					
6	Central	130	140	8%					

Double-click, Enter or F2 to edit a cell. Click row/column heads to select whole lines. Right-click for actions. Ctrl+Z undoes. Blue column = categories, tinted header = series.

Double-click, Enter or F2 edits a cell. Insert and delete rows and columns, move rows, promote a row to header, transpose, undo (Ctrl+Z), export CSV. The blue column is the category column; dimmed columns are series switched off.

Amend

Charts already on this slide

Pasted · column · 9/27/2026

Amend

Keep position

Every inserted chart stores its data, series setup, annotations and settings inside the Figma node. Select the chart in Figma (or pick it from the list) and click Amend: the panel restores exactly. Change anything, then Replace chart. Keep position leaves it where you put it.

All tables → slides

Every table in the file (each sheet, each block separated by blank rows) becomes a chart on its own slide, cloned from the target slide, chart type auto-picked per table unless you chose one.

Client sent v2? Amend the chart, load the new file, Replace. Same slide, same position, new numbers.

Shortcuts, licence, troubleshooting

Key	Does
Ctrl + Enter	Insert chart
Ctrl + Z (Data tab)	Undo last data edit
Enter / F2	Edit the selected cell
Double-click preview	Full-screen preview: scroll to zoom, drag to pan, 0 fits, Esc closes
Click a bar / point / slice	Add an annotation there
► under the preview	Replay the grow-in animation
🔊 in the header	Sound on / off

Licence

ChartDrop asks for a licence key the first time it opens on a Mac and remembers it. The key is checked online each time the plugin opens; it keeps working offline for 7 days on the last good answer. **Licence** in the header shows who it is licensed to and lets you switch keys.

If something looks off

- **No slides listed:** open a Figma Slides deck. In a Design file, top-level frames act as slides. Click ⌘ after adding one.
- **Wrong colours:** ChartDrop uses the saturated fills it finds on your slides. Style → Palette → Hue spread, or tick "Use the colour overrides".
- **Wrong category column:** Series → Category column.
- **Everything in one series:** the sheet has rows as series. Chart tab → Rows are series.
- **Preview shows no chart:** no numeric column was found. Check the Data tab; numbers with text around them ("12 units") are not read as numbers.
- **Fonts differ:** the deck font is not installed on this Mac. Style → Fonts shows what Figma has.
- **Google Sheets link fails:** paste the range instead. It is faster anyway.

Milestones

ChartDrop counts your inserts in the header pill. At 1, 10, 25, 50, 100, 250, 500 and 1000 charts it rains. With sound, unless you muted it. Ctrl+Shift+R if you just want to see it.

